

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] We are recording. All right. Thank you again for participating in this interview. As I mentioned, over text. We just want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. And we think your experience and your perspective would bring a lot to the project. Before we begin, is it all right if we record the interview? Only use it for transcription purposes?

Speaker 2 [00:00:24] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:26] And first question. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:29] [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:00:31] And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:37] And do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:39] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:41] Who lives in your household.

Speaker 2 [00:00:44] Myself and my girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:00:46] And what's your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:00:50] I work for [Company].

Speaker 1 [00:00:55] What is your position at [Company]?

Speaker 2 [00:00:57] I'm a [occupation] for [Company].

Speaker 1 [00:01:03] That's cool. Do you like repair stuff?

Speaker 2 [00:01:06] I [occupation]?

Speaker 1 [00:01:13] That's really cool, actually. Do you like it?

Speaker 2 [00:01:16] Oh, it's fun.

Speaker 1 [00:01:17] Yeah, That sounds like a lot of fun. You didn't have to go to school or anything, right? You just started working.

Speaker 2 [00:01:22] Yeah, I just. I started in, like, a really low position. And then eventually, after a couple of years, I moved up.

Speaker 1 [00:01:29] Nice for you. That's awesome. And, um. How would you like us to address your partner, girlfriend, lover, her name?

Speaker 2 Girlfriend.

Speaker 1 So can you start off by telling me a little about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:01:49] So my girlfriend and I, named [Partner's Name]. We actually met through a dating app called [Name]. It's an app where the girl has to say something first. And I'd spent a while using it. I had seen my friends like using it and they would always like find hookups and stuff. And I was never like a like a hookup type of person. And so I've always, like, struggled, like trying to find somebody to talk to or anything, because everyone that you would see on there was just trying to get a quick, quick match, meet up and then never talk to again.

Speaker 1 [00:02:26] Like Tinder, almost?

Speaker 2 [00:02:28] Yeah, pretty much all my like, all my friends are doing it. And I, I, you know, I was like, that's cool for them. But I never saw anything from it. And then I saw a message from my girlfriend and I immediately was like, Wow, she's really pretty. Like, she had a really nice picture. She had a bunch of pictures. She had a picture of her skating too, which definitely was out of the ordinary for any girl on there. So I was like, okay, that's pretty cool.

Speaker 1 [00:02:56] But she was not really a [interest]?

Speaker 2 [00:03:00] Not a [interest], but so definitely try to use it to our advantage. Yeah, like does a girl swipe right? And then she responded with, Hey, that was it. And I tried to like, make full conversation with her or I try to like, you know, be all flirty with her. And she gave me really dry one word responses.

Speaker 1 [00:03:21] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:03:23] I told her I was like, all right. I don't know why I said this instead of phone number, but I was like, Oh, let me get your [Social Media] partner, [Social Media]. And then like [1-5] days later, Oh, can I get your phone number? So I got her phone.

Speaker 1 [00:03:39] That's.

Speaker 2 [00:03:41] Yeah, for a while we were just texting and stuff and I had just started working on a [Company Name]. And then after working at [Company Name], I worked like [Company Name], so I was like already super like busy working. As I was talking to her and for the first month or so or few weeks, I didn't get to like actually meet her in person. And I didn't have my car because my car was in the shop and I didn't want to pull up in my mom's car and have it make it like a really awkward situation. But in the meantime, like while we couldn't see each other physically, I would facetime a lot, like every night, almost for hours on it.

Speaker 1 [00:04:23] Did you meet up with her in person before you started Facetime?

Speaker 2 [00:04:28] No.

Speaker 1 [00:04:29] Oh. You just face time before you even met in person?

Speaker 2 [00:04:32] Yeah. So we had talked for a while, and then, like, we were texting and stuff and I was like, Oh, no face time. And then so we had face time for a bit, I think. Well, actually. Maybe we did meet in person before face time. I'm not. I can't really remember exactly. I just know there was a long time where we had faced timed them, like

every night. But I wasn't able to drive there because I didn't have my car. And I was like super embarrassed. But then when I did get it, we went on a date and like, you know, we spent a lot of time together and like. We ended up. What do we do? Like we went [activity]. We sat out at her high school parking lot and saw like a shooting star in the middle of, like, the city. We're just super.

Speaker 1 [00:05:24] Super rare. Yeah. Especially at that parking lot. Like, there's so many lights over there. That's awesome.

Speaker 2 [00:05:33] Yeah. It was really bright and we could still see and we both sat at the same time. And I learned a lot about her and like, what she liked to do and like things she liked and like who she was. And like, after I saw the shooting star, I got like, you know, I was, like, really interested in, like, being with her. But I didn't know she felt the same way. So I still had like. Go about that. And I would take her on dates and stuff and we went to the aquarium. One day. And then. I think that same day we went to the aquarium, we were driving back to her house and then I reached out to hold her hand and then she held my hand. She's like, Wow. It's almost like we're boyfriend and girlfriend. And I said, okay, do you want to be my girlfriend? And then she, like, smiled and said, Yeah. And so ever since then, we've been together for [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:06:23] Oh, wow. That's a good story. I like that. Why did you ask? Let me. Let me guess. On the shooting star. Did you wish for her to be your girlfriend or like.

Speaker 2 [00:06:36] I didn't even wish anything because I was, like, so nervous. I was like, oh, my God. Like, what the hell just happened?

Speaker 1 [00:06:42] You forgot the main purpose of the shooting star. Either way, though, it all worked out. That's cute. So how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:07:02] Definitely a lot better than most. I see a lot of my friends, like they've gone in and out of relationships pretty quickly. One of my current friends is like going through like a like a. Break up in make up type of thing, but it's like constantly, like every week. And so I think the quality of my relationship is so, so good, and especially in comparison to other people's.

Speaker 1 [00:07:27] Yeah, like a lot more consistent.

Speaker 2 [00:07:30] Consistent and like there's no, like, wondering what's going to happen every day. Like, I don't have to worry about the next day and like, Oh, is this person going to feel, you know, is my girlfriend going to feel a different way today than she did? Or she gonna, you know, freak out and get all emotional about something when, like, you know.

Speaker 1 [00:07:47] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:07:49] I've got one for that.

Speaker 1 [00:07:51] Yeah. So you feel like secured.

Speaker 2 [00:07:54] That. Here the down.

Speaker 1 [00:07:58] Why do you think that? Like that there's such a difference between your relationship and your friend's relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:08:07] I think it was more of what my girlfriend were looking for. We were definitely both like. More interested in being with each other long term. And like we saw something in each other that you don't really get with too many people. I think the difference was that we went through a lot of hard times and we both had to like check our own egos a lot. Mostly like me, more than her. But I would have to check myself in like. You know, bring myself back to reality. Like, okay, like some things we would argue about were not right. Some things like I felt were like, well, not right on her part or vice versa. And eventually I just learned to, like, talk about it and not like overreact because I always felt horrible at the end of the day. And then like. By the end of the conversation, I was always like, listen, like this was really dumb. Like, you know, I apologize for happened. Like, you know, I think we need to talk more about it. And like too many of those times happened to the point where I was like, okay, like. Like de-escalate the situation and talk about it before it becomes something major like an argument or, you know, like one of us is like getting angry over something.

Speaker 1 [00:09:24] Right? So you feel like your friends, like, lack that quality.

Speaker 2 [00:09:29] Yeah, they like, like an empathetic. I guess, feeling towards, like the relationship. Yeah. That they more care about like what their life is, not like what their life is like, what their partner, what their partners life is like. And you know, they're more for focus inner the brother rather than outer.

Speaker 1 [00:09:54] You know, I go more selfish on like, Oh, they're not doing this for me. Then like, yeah, I think so. Can I ask how many romantic partners you have in the past? And you could define that however you like.

Speaker 2 [00:10:13] I had [1-5] girlfriend for [6-10] months when I was in [6th-10th] grade, and then that was definitely like looking back at it now. It was really cheesy and like, I didn't know anything about anything. So that was like the first one. I think you like it.

Speaker 1 [00:10:30] That's really solid.

Speaker 2 [00:10:33] Yeah, that was pretty good. And then after that, like, I would like randomly, like, talk to a bunch of different girls, like, because, like, I had broken up with that girl. And then I realized, like, oh, I could do with one. I could, you know, pretty much try to get any girl. So then I became like a little player and, you know, for a while and then. Yeah. I mean, I like, talk to a lot of girls. I really, like, try to have relationships with anybody. Yeah, I think romantically, probably like [1-5] or [1-5], including like [6th-10th] grade, but not enough to where I can remember.

Speaker 1 [00:11:18] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:11:19] It's like not like a significant part of my life. And it wasn't like a great part of my life, but. Yeah, I think. It was at least for. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:11:33] And now how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:11:42] You a lot better because, you know, almost like [6-10], [6-10] years older. Than those situations. So a lot more mature and like I know what I want out of it. My just doing it because I think I can.

Speaker 1 [00:12:01] Yeah. Yeah. I see. And for you, what makes a relationship high quality.

Speaker 2 [00:12:11] I think being able to spend quality time with, you know, your partner or like my in my case, like being able to spend quality time with my girlfriend or being able to talk about things that I'm worried about or she's worried about and like always being there. So I'd be a shoulder to lean on. Even when you disagree with something they say, you know, or if they do the same. And I always kind of like being like a like a backbone when you can't have one.

Speaker 1 [00:12:44] Yeah. So you feel like you have a support. A support system like this one. And. What would you say makes a low quality relationship and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:13:00] Having a lot of trust issues. I'm always constantly worrying about what the other person is doing. Yeah. Being selfish, I think that's like reiterating because then, you know, you're not caring about what the other person is doing in a sense that benefits you, but you only care if it's not benefiting you. And then you like, you know, those treasured trust issues become anger, become jealousy or like envy. And then eventually you start to, like, lash out in different ways, like, you know, verbally, physically. Like, those are like, low quality relationship things.

Speaker 1 [00:13:40] Yeah. And so when you say like you feel really open to talk about whatever you want. And have a shoulder to lean on, when would you say it was most like that in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:56] Definitely some points where I would. I, like struggled with, like, mild depression, I guess, or I don't know how to explain it, but like. I would definitely like questioned life a lot. And I like I had a pretty bad habit of like jumping in and out of that. So I would be like, fine for a while and then just get really low and like start to like lost it. And I wouldn't say anything about it until like, I like. Um, pretty much like, exploded from the pressure. Like this is a few times and like every time, like. You know, my girlfriend always had not really results, but more of just like better for me and like better like support me and let me know like I don't need to hold it in and stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:14:44] Yeah. Just like, better for you to talk about it.

Speaker 2 [00:14:47] Yeah. And also making like, life decisions, like taking a job, you know, that I'm really, like, nervous about or. You know, like starting a hobby, like, you know, doing like, [interest] or like. You know, going. I guess like becoming like a fitness driven because like, you know, that depression also came into contact with self-consciousness and worrying about like, oh, well, you know what? If I'm not good enough for you, like.

Speaker 1 [00:15:19] You know.

Speaker 2 [00:15:19] Then she was all like, Oh, you know, if you are, you just need to, like, push yourself.

Speaker 1 [00:15:25] Yes. She got you, like, kind of out of your comfort zone.

Speaker 2 [00:15:29] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:30] And when would you say it was the least of, like, you know, feeling like you had support or, you know. The least of all that.

Speaker 2 [00:15:42] Um. That's a good one. I mean. There wasn't really too many situations like that. I think. There were some points where like, some, like, personal stuff happened, like family. And I was like, I don't really know what to do. And I could tell that, like, my girlfriend didn't really know what to do either. And so I was I felt like kind of like stuck. Like I didn't have any support, which wasn't necessarily her fault or my fault, but it was just like, she can do anything for me. And I had like, I had to deal with that.

Speaker 1 [00:16:19] Yeah, like you didn't have anybody that could relate to you or just, like, to a resolution of what was going on.

Speaker 2 [00:16:26] Yeah, because I was it was more of like, my own personal issue that, you know, not a lot of people have experienced the same way. Like my girlfriend would had to have something like in her in her past, like, I don't know how to deal with. Yeah. So it was kind of something where would. I had to learn how to deal with that on my own. And she was there by my side. But she didn't. She couldn't help me in really any way. So it kind of felt like I was, like, alone.

Speaker 1 [00:16:55] Okay, well, that's a sad but good example. And can you tell me more about how one knows when they're in a secured relationship or when you feel like you're able to open up to somebody, even if it is really extremely hard?

Speaker 2 [00:17:17] I think knowing you're in a secure relationship is just being able to trust them and being able to, like, not worry about their every move. Knowing that like, they'll make a good decision for themselves and for you. Even if it's not in your own best interests. Like you might go make a make a decision for me that I don't agree with, and then a couple months later, I'll be like, Wow, I'm so glad you said that. To do that instead of what I wanted to do. Because like, now I see. Like, I would have screwed myself over. It's like that, you know, being able to trust. Their decision making, their thought process there. You know, everything that revolves around them being a partner to you is what makes it.

Speaker 1 [00:18:05] Did she show you? Why did she show you that she was like a good decision maker and trustworthy? Was that like when it happened or was it before like something happened? Like, did you already know before that she was like a trustworthy and good decision maker? Or was it because of like, the results of her decisions make it very.

Speaker 2 [00:18:27] Yeah, I think it was the results. Like towards the beginning of a relationship. There were a few like questionable things in that, like, you know, made me wonder like, okay, like is her, is her thought process like in a same line as mine? Like, am I really making the right decision for myself by letting her, like, make these decisions, you know, for me or for herself, too. And. Over time. Like being able to talk about it, I think is what helped me realize, like, okay, now she's making the right decisions. I just had to come back like how I felt about it. And, you know, we could go back and forth.

Speaker 1 [00:19:07] Yeah. Like work out it together and, like, throw ideas out there. And for you, what is the most important thing in a relationship and why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:19:21] Oh, no. I think again, trust. Trust. And also like. Not worrying about what you're going to have to do with them to make them happy. Like being able to spend time just even sitting there. Just like. Next to each other, I think is a big one. Like being able to be together with, you know. No need to worry about like, how am I going to please to make sure they're still happy and. You know?

Speaker 1 [00:19:54] Yeah. And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:20:02] Love is thinking about a future with someone and being able to know that. They're they care about you and they are interested in your life and like what You know, your successes because they see you as like, you know, something that's. I guess, has a purpose.

Speaker 1 [00:20:24] Has potential.

Speaker 2 [00:20:25] Has potential to, like, make a well-being for themselves and. Or each other, I guess. Love is. Love is. Just knowing that like, you can always be there for that person and you can always have that person there for you and also see them like grow and succeed and like do amazing things and still like come back to know like, you know, they're going to trust you and they're going to receive you with open arms and always like, you know, have their best interests for you.

Speaker 1 [00:20:58] Yeah. Yeah. You're very quick answer for that. A lot of people struggle on that question. And how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:09] Extremely.

Speaker 1 [00:21:11] Let me break it.

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Oh, like on a scale. I mean, like.

Speaker 1 [00:21:18] If you had to go from, like, number one most important thing to three, like, down, where would you put it at?

Speaker 2 [00:21:27] Oh, definitely a one, like most important.

Speaker 1 [00:21:29] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:21:31] I think because you can be in relationship, but you can't. Love somebody and, you know, actually be in a relationship. Yeah. It's not the same shit. No.

Speaker 1 [00:21:44] And how. How do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:50] Because she worries about me in the right way and she wants me to succeed and make good choices and like what I can. You know what I can't answer on the phone or, you know what I'm doing. Like when I'm working, she's like always sending me messages or like, when we're hanging out together and she, like, wants to snuggle up or always, like, has good ideas for things to do together and being able to, like, know, like,

oh, well, like in the future we can do this and you know, we can like we should go here and have fun. Like. Just like. Always like wanting to, like, be together and, you know, have like, a good time and just enjoy each other's company.

Speaker 1 [00:22:34] She always wants to spend time with you. And going back, actually, I wanted to ask. So before when I asked, like, what was the most important thing in our relationship? One of the things the first thing you said was trust. Now, do you think that love is more important than trust in our relationship, or what is your opinions on? On that.

Speaker 2 [00:23:04] Um. I mean, I don't really think there is trust without love. Because if you don't completely love someone, well. No, I think they kind of like intertwine with each other because if you trust someone enough, it shows that you love them and you can like, say, like, okay, I believe in you. And if you love someone enough like you can trust that they're going to do the right thing or you can trust that they like are who they say they are and they're not like showing you like a facade and wearing a mask. I think they can balance each other. I don't think they're like more important or less important than. Then themselves.

Speaker 1 [00:23:47] Now they go hand in hand. And. Okay. So now going back, what would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:00] Thinking about the future, thinking about our both of our careers and what we want to do. I think that's probably the biggest challenge. Right now, I don't really see any other challenges. There are some days where, like I do get pretty complacent and don't always like express, but I like, you know. And try to show that love. So like. I think that is a big challenge for me is like being able to like, show that I that I love her. Like, even though I know she knows. Like she still would want to see it physically and like, you know, she wants me to reassure her that like, I'm on there and stuff. And that's like a challenge I struggle with in the relationship is. Being able to express my. My love for her thoroughly and consistently.

Speaker 1 [00:24:59] Yeah. Yeah. Have you, like, done anything or, like, try to work on it? Like, shouldn't it be better at that?

Speaker 2 [00:25:08] Yeah, I. Being by myself, like driving home from work. I do like. Think about a lot of things and think about like, oh, you know, like, you know, I'm glad that I have her to be there for me because, like, I don't know where I would be now if I if I had never met her or like if I wasn't here anymore. And like, you know, she would always like, I know she would still care about me. So, like, those are the things I like think of to bring myself back in. Just a lot of, like, personal thinking, like reflecting. Um, I've done some, like, journaling before and just try to, like, you know, realize like, okay, what? Like, why am I, like, getting so complacent? And I talked to, like, a couple of, like, coworkers about it. Like, you know, some of my supervisors used to, like, have one on ones with me and, like, get real deep and personal and be like, you know, why do you why do you not, like, show as much? Like there are things that like psychological you might be doing and like. So, like, treating myself like, you know, like even like seeing her name in a sentence. If it's, you know, she and I, I'm always saying shit and I am saying, Oh, yeah, like I did. This was [Partner's Name]. It's always [Partner's Name] and I because [Partner's Name] is first and I'm like, Yeah, I would say she's first, which means I need to like, show her that she is first and also show her that I love her.

Speaker 1 [00:26:31] Yeah. And it's like, I mean, that's definitely hard to do because sometimes you, you get in your own head, you kind of forget, like to be like, Oh, you look so pretty. Even though you're thinking it sometimes you like, forget to say or do like, you just like, don't really think to say it. Or just like, even if you're thinking like, Oh, I love her so much. Like sometimes you like, you just like, don't vocalize it. I'm not saying you do, but like, you know, people don't.

Speaker 2 [00:26:58] Even like knowing. Like knowing she's beautiful but not telling her she's beautiful. And then she starts to feel like she's not because I don't say it. And I do think it. If I don't say it, then, you know, she's she might not feel like I actually feel that way.

Speaker 1 [00:27:11] Yeah, exactly. It's like making mental notes to just, like, be more vocal about like, how you feel, you know? That's definitely something that's really hard to do.

Speaker 2 [00:27:21] Yeah. It's hard. It's not impossible, but it just. It takes a lot of practice. Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:27:28] And do you and your partner fight? And how often would you say these fights are rare?

Speaker 2 [00:27:41] Very rare.

Speaker 1 [00:27:43] Give me an occurrence. Weekly? Monthly?

Speaker 2 [00:27:48] Every quarter, like a quarter of a year, maybe like every few months we would have fighting or argued.

Speaker 1 [00:27:58] Like, would you refer to these as big fights or small fights?

Speaker 2 [00:28:02] Um. I mean, I'll get talking about big fights. Like. Like monthly, maybe like every few months. Small fights, maybe like every every couple of weeks. The small fights are usually about really, like, minor things that, you know, we can easily talk about and. Yeah, it's just like really minor stuff. Like, Oh, you forgot to text me when you're home. All I'm sorry. Like, I got busy. Like, that's my bad. Like, I'm going to do it next time. And then big fights, like, you know. Coming home from, like, you know, being out and then it's like one in the morning and like, I'm super exhausted. But then she's like, oh, you know, you don't show me enough attention or this or that. And I'm like, Dude, I'm too tired. I can't deal with this shit right now. Like, just let's talk about it tomorrow. And then it's then it becomes like, Oh, I don't want to talk about it tomorrow. I can't talk about it now. Well, I don't know. I feel like you're not caring about my feelings. Well, I do, but I just can't do it right now and then, you know, it's like a constant cycle and then just, like, builds up. So the bigger ones are rare, but they do have happen every few months.

Speaker 1 [00:29:12] Okay. And how do you resolve like those types of fights, like either one or both? How would you resolve, like, small fights and big fights?

Speaker 2 [00:29:25] Small fights, just like being reassuring and like, you know, always saying like, oh, yeah, you know. Like just I'll try to hold myself accountable in those situations or like if you can do the same. Like, I'd appreciate. I think. Like do and like would things where it's like it's easy to talk about. But then what? The big fights, it's kind of like. Problem. It'll be a situation where, like, both of us will get so angry. You know, like be

irritated at each other for a while and then, like, eventually want. I've also break agreements, situations where I've said like, oh, you know, honestly, like this is such a dumb fight. If this started over the smallest thing, like, you know, I think we need to just like, chill out and like, you know, then we end up talking about it and it all like, at the end of the day, all the big and small fights get resolved by saying like, listen, this was not great. But like, you know, next time can we at least do this or that or can we talk about it first? Like here, we like make sure you know, oh, next time if you feel a certain way, just let me know. And it, you know, if it's like super early tonight, we'll talk about it in the morning. And we're both like calm and refreshed, you know.

Speaker 1 [00:30:50] Is it coming to a compromise.

Speaker 2 [00:30:52] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:30:54] And do you like usually talk or have a resolution like quickly or does it take a little while.

Speaker 2 [00:31:03] It takes a while with the bigger fights. Because like in the heat of the moment, you're like, so emotional that, like, sometimes you just don't get, you know, like, give a shit about what the resolution is like. You just wanna be right. Yeah. So like, any person would want to want to be right, even if they know they're wrong. But the smaller ones, it is pretty easy because like. You want to avoid those bigger fights. Like if especially if you know it's pointless and you can like easily like, suck it up and say like, hey, like, you know, I fucked up. But next time, like, I want, you know, I'll try better.

Speaker 1 [00:31:39] Yeah. Yeah, I definitely. That's like, honestly, I feel like the best way to go about it. You kind of just have to, like, put your ego down a lot. Like, I'm sorry.

Speaker 2 [00:31:51] Yeah. It's harder. And it's harder for for both of us to do that sometimes. But I think eventually one of us cracks. Like, you know, we'll always like at the end of the day, talk about it. It just takes some time.

Speaker 1 [00:32:07] Yeah. Just got to get them emotions down a little bit.

Speaker 2 [00:32:11] Yep.

Speaker 1 [00:32:12] And just get tired of, like, being mad. I feel like that's what I like. I'm like, I'm tired of being mad. I'm just like, stop whining.

Speaker 2 [00:32:19] Are you like, are you are irritated. You're irritated by the fact that you're like, pissed, stop. And then you're like, why am I even pissed off? Like, honestly, like, it seems so pointless now. Like, you look at it and you're like, Damn, like if I was looking at two other people arguing about this, I'd probably be like, Wow, they look like fucking dummies. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:32:38] Don't you be laughing at them and be like, You guys just wasted your life time doing all that.

Speaker 2 [00:32:44] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:32:45] And aside just from talking about it and coming to a compromise, what are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:32:58] I mean, going on dates, spending time, going like, hiking and stuff. Obviously, everyone's favorite sex is a great one.

Speaker 1 [00:33:10] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:33:14] Yeah, I think like. Like cooking dinner together is like a good one because, like, we're having fun, you know, we're like, making something, doing our own thing. Like doing a lot of, like, our arts and crafts projects together. Just kind of like spending time doing random things like you wouldn't do by yourself.

Speaker 1 [00:33:33] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:33:34] With another person, like, Oh, that's pretty fun. Like, you know, it's really enjoyable.

Speaker 1 [00:33:38] Yeah, I would definitely. And Would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:33:47] Definitely it's good for me because before I was like really lonely. Before I met my girlfriend, I was really lonely. I felt like. Like life was pretty pointless. Like. I was, like, too afraid to live and too afraid to die. At the same time, like, I just, like, was stuck in a rut of like, oh, I don't know what to do. But now, like, I've grown, like, like I take care of my health. Like, I've been a lot of, like, good personal choices, like, oh, you know, like I've, I've, like, spent time in the gym. I've stopped, like, drinking. Stop smoking. I like watching right now. Like, I make sure I, like, don't listen or see like things on my phone or like around. I don't like hang out with bad influences like before. Like I didn't have like, someone to say, like, that's not good for you. This is not good for you.

Speaker 2 [00:34:40] You know?

Speaker 2 [00:34:41] But now, yeah, it keeps me in check. And like, she calls me out the shit that I don't see and like, helps me realize, like, damn, like, maybe I do need to take a step back, but before, like, I could, you know, someone can hand me a joint or something or like, say like, Oh, you want to go drinking in like the middle of the night or something? And I'll be like, Yeah, I'm down. Like, when I realized it was a bad thing for me, you know?

Speaker 2 [00:35:07] And with the health choices and being more active was more like, you just want to feel good about yourself or wish you just like, we should go start getting more fit. Like how did that go about how she influence that?

Speaker 2 [00:35:24] Wait. Oh, hold on real quick. Can you pause it?

speaker 2 had to open the door for his girlfriend

Speaker 1 [00:35:27] Yeah. All right. It's recording.

Speaker 2 [00:35:32] Yeah. So I think the reason why she influenced me is because she saw that I would spend a lot of time like I would smoke and then get high and then I would like get really lazy and like sometimes fall asleep, like sitting on my couch or something. Mm hmm. I was wasting a lot of time, just, like, doing nothing. And, like, she started going to the gym on her own just cause she, like, like to do it. She was enjoying it. And that she,

like, said to me one day, she's like. Like instead of smoking, you can literally just go to the gym. And I was like, Well, I mean, I don't really like feel the need to quit smoking, but like, I'll still go to the gym because like, I can, you know, and like in my past, like when I was, you know, in middle school and stuff, I always wanted to be like that kid who, like, went to the gym and like, you know, worked out. But I never, ever committed to it. Like, I would do it for like three days nonstop. So. She saw a good way for me to, like, change my habits. And then so I was like, okay, I'll give it a shot. And then I would do it for like, you know, a month or so and then stop going for like a week and then go back in my car, back and forth until eventually I started going like every single week, like, you know, [1-5] days out of the week, so like the past couple of years strictly because she to like, oh, you should just change your habits not because she was like I feel better about yourself after like she just thought it would be a good way for me to stop being lazy and stop like, you know, doing stupid shit, like sitting at home and doing nothing all day.

Speaker 1 [00:37:07] Yeah, Especially if she's being active. You know, it's kind of like if you guys aren't on the same page about like, how you want your lifestyles to be, It's like, makes things a lot more complicated. And would you say, did the relationship change you and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:37:29] Yeah. Ah, it did change me. Only because. Oh, no, I think I answered that one already.

Speaker 1 [00:37:38] Did you?

Speaker 2 [00:37:41] Maybe. I can't really answer it.

Speaker 1 [00:37:44] Maybe you just really answer it because I think, yeah, maybe you just re answer it just in case. But yeah, you could just kind of repeat the same things. Or if you have anything new to add.

Speaker 2 [00:37:54] Yeah. I mean, I was like, I was like a lonely and, like, sad kid before I met my girlfriend. And, like, I, you know, I was always surrounded by bad influences and didn't really, like, noticed or care to change that. And like I was making a lot of dumb choices and like had a lot of issues not only with people, but like, with myself and like, you know, always stuck in a rut of like. Where I was and what I wanted out of life. And like if I wanted anything, I life. And then after I got into my relationship, I realized, like, wow, there's like, stuff I could actually care about, like things I really enjoyed doing and, like, being around, like, this person, you know, my girlfriend, like, all the time, like, actually makes me feel happy and like, good inside about myself and also good for, like, being there for her. And it made me a more, a lot more mature because I realized, like, I didn't need certain things in my life that I like, you know, thought I should care about, like smoking, drinking. You know, like not taking care of my health, being around, like, you know, bad influences. Like dealing with a lot of, like, family issues that I didn't know how to handle. Like it like, made me realize, like, I can handle that. And I can also, like, be immature about it and like, make the right choices for me. Like, you know, my family, myself, everyone. Pretty much.

Speaker 1 [00:39:21] Okay. And now what about your partner or your girlfriend? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:39:30] Yeah, I think I think she changed. She was going through a lot of personal stuff and she had a lot of issues that she never really talked about with anyone

because she didn't have anyone there for her. And during the span of like the beginning of our relationship, up until now, there were a lot of points where, like, she would kind of like, break under pressure and tell me things about herself that I was like, wow. Like, you know, but you deal with these things, but don't ever say anything about it. And like, you know, it's a good way for you to, like, learn and grow and like, try to understand, like the way you're feeling about it and like, how you might like different differentiate, like your life then versus now and. Like she definitely made a lot of, like, not great choices, not bad, but not great choices in her past. You know, being a lot younger and like before. But now, like, she she, like, cares about her well-being and she cares about, like, you know, her family's well-being and her friend's well-being and like, what she wants to do in life and like, what she wants to get out of it. And like, she's a lot more like, like bubbly and enjoyable to, like, be around for everybody around her and like. You know, like, she looks. She like, looks different. She, like, looks like more mature and she doesn't act. She acts like, you know, like a grown woman who, like, is, you know, good for herself and, like, good at everything she can do.

Speaker 1 [00:41:01] Yeah. Sounds like you guys, like, pretty much change a lot in similar ways, but, kind of like, you know, different. But like, the end of the day, it all sounds like basically the same, same stuff. Like you started being more like enjoying things more, both you guys and like even people enjoy being probably around you guys more because you guys are more like happier.

Speaker 2 [00:41:27] Yeah, I think. I think like our moods and like, personalities definitely switched up.

Speaker 1 [00:41:34] You know, you guys kind of just, like, brought out, like, the best sides of you guys.

Speaker 2 [00:41:38] Everyone.

Speaker 1 [00:41:40] And do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:41:46] I do feel safe because I know that when I make bad choices that my girlfriend will always be there to support me and tell me when I fucked up and when I'm like doing the right thing. At least like what she thinks and know not tell me like this decision you have to make, but like not knowing that she'll support me and, like, let me know when I screw up. But let me like, decide for myself at the end of the day.

Speaker 1 [00:42:13] And can you give me an example of that?

Speaker 2 [00:42:22] I think like a good personal example. My like, my dad went to jail recently and like, I was I was stuck between, like, you know, oh, do I bail him out of jail and like, help him get out or do I let him stay in there to, like, deal with whatever he's dealing with? Because I'm only a [20-25] year old, You know, I can't, like, deal with this for an adult. Yeah. And, like, stuck in between, like, those choices for a couple of days, and, like, I just, like, split decision was like, okay, I'm going to bail them out. Like, I just feel like that's, like, ethically the right thing to do for me and her and what she did as she told me, like, okay, you know, like I think, I think the choice you made wasn't, you know, bad or good. But I think, like, you know, you are putting a lot of pressure on yourself. So definitely, like, you know, try to watch out for like what you're dealing with and like make sure you're not putting it on you because it's not on you. But. Make the decision that you think is right, not the decision that you want everyone else to think is right.

Speaker 1 [00:43:24] Yeah, that's actually like really good. My thought process about that because it's definitely not your responsibility. I mean, it's not your kid. You know, like if it was your kid, like, maybe, but.

Speaker 2 [00:43:38] Yeah, it's a whole different way. Yeah. I think when it's a parent like and you're still like super young and then you don't really know what to do in that situation.

Speaker 1 [00:43:47] Yeah. Sorry you had to go through that. That's fucked up.

Speaker 2 [00:43:51] Yeah, it is what it is. Like valuable lessons for everybody involved.

Speaker 1 [00:43:57] So would you end up deciding if you don't mind me asking?

Speaker 2 [00:44:01] So I did bail my dad out of jail, you know? Yeah. He was. He was dealing with a lot of, like, alcohol problems. And I think, like, this stemmed from, like, he had, like, a like a failing relationship with a girlfriend on top of, like, he had lost his dad, like. Like. A few years ago and his dad wasn't really part of his life. But when his dad was dying, my dad was like the only sibling out of all of his siblings to to step up and like, take care of him, like, until the day he died and be there for him and, yeah, drive out like two hours to see him, like every, you know, two days at least and just make sure like he was okay. And he felt like he was loved and cared about. And so, like, losing a dad, having a failing relationship tournament, like, you know, just like a sad, closed out guy who, like, just turned to alcohol and. After I bailed him out. I told them like, listen, like I love you and I care about you and I want you to, like, be a part of my future. And if you want to be a part of my life. Like he'd already had a falling out with all the rest of my siblings. I was like, the last one you pretty much had. And I told him, like, if you want to be a part of my life, you're going to quit drinking and you're going to start going to AA meetings and like taking care of your health and like, making good decisions And like, that was like, the first time I ever saw my dad, like, cry and, like, really, like, feel emotion and, like, tell me the truth about things and not, like, sugarcoat everything. And so, like. Like that decision of like, bailing him out definitely helped me, like. Like, kind of like realign my relationship with him in a better way for, like, myself and him, because then it made him realize, like, damn, I got to step, like, step up. Like as a person. Not just like a dad, but just I was like, you know, help me realize, like. Like. All right. Like shit's real. Like, sometimes you just got to be honest with people.

Speaker 1 [00:46:07] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:46:09] I think that's what I was afraid of, is like, if I did bail him out, like I was going to have to do all that, and if I didn't bail them out, that I was still going to have to deal with that just in a whole different type of way.

Speaker 1 [00:46:19] Yeah. But it seems like it came out for the better. Is he doing better now?

Speaker 2 [00:46:24] Yeah, he's doing better. He's. He's been sober for a while.

Speaker 1 [00:46:29] Good for him. There you go.

Speaker 2 [00:46:31] I like that. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:46:33] And at least something like really good came out of that decision, so.

Speaker 2 [00:46:39] Yeah, definitely.

Speaker 1 [00:46:41] All right, so.

Speaker 2 [00:46:41] We're almost done?

Speaker 1 [00:46:44] No, go ahead.

Speaker 2 [00:46:45] But I completely lost my train of thought.

Speaker 1 [00:46:48] We're almost done. So now it's time for a slide show. I'm going to share my screen. Almost. Yeah. I hate making them, but they're definitely fun to look at. Oh, that's cool. I could just show you this. Like so new to using in. Oh, that's cool.

Speaker 2 [00:47:17] Cool.

Speaker 1 [00:47:18] You can see it, right?

Speaker 2 [00:47:19] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:47:22] let me play. Okay, wait. Let me make sure. So for the first statement, my partner usually really listens to me. How would you rank that from one not true at all to nine completely true.

Speaker 2 [00:47:45] Uh, nine.

Speaker 1 [00:47:51] And then for the statement, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. How would you rate it? One not. Not at all true to nine. Completely true.

Speaker 2 [00:48:04] Seven.

Speaker 1 [00:48:08] And how satisfied are you with your relationship? From completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:48:17] Um. completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:48:21] And how would you rate it on a number scale from not satisfied at all from 0 to 10 completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:48:29] I would say an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:48:34] All right. Well, that's it for the slide show. And I got some follow up questions. So when you when I asked about the statement, my partner usually really listens to me. You answered a nine, I believe. Completely true. And can you give me an example of when this happened or when this has happened?

Speaker 2 [00:49:03] Just like dealing with stuff everyday, like work stuff and. Talking about, like, things that happen daily and like, why I like why I'm upset about something or why, like, disagree to something and. Like my girlfriend will, like usually be like, oh, yeah, you know, like it doesn't like, I guess an example is like I was, I was irritated because, like.

I was trying to build stuff, but I'm not qualified completely. But they're like rushing me to build it. I'm, like, stuck between like, I can do it, but I still am not technically, like, able to do it to a point.

Speaker 1 [00:49:41] Oh, like, legally you're not allowed to do it.

Speaker 2 [00:49:45] I mean, not legally, but like through the company. Like what are through like my position, like if I had to build certain. Yeah. Just like the job position qualification. Oh, I have to, like, train more to do it. But they're like, trying, like, cut corners so that like, I can do it without having to, like, train completely. And then, like. Yeah. They're like, you know, like they're making some decisions that I don't agree with. So, like, I would, you know, I told my girlfriend, like, you know, oh, yeah, they did some, some shit to me. Like, I think it was stupid, like, why can't they just let me do it? And she's like, Yeah, yeah. It doesn't really make any sense. Like, I think, you know, I think if they're like pushing you to do it, like they might as well let you do it. And then the next day, like, I screwed something up and I told her I was like, Yeah, I screwed something up. So, like, now I feel like I'm just like, eating my words and like, kind of taking back what I said because now I'm, like, embarrassed. I like, they think I'm not capable, even though I was, like, acting cocky the day before and saying like, oh, you know, I could easily do. And she's like, Yeah, I mean, I think you're still confident. I think you just need to understand, you know? Like you fail, but you also like, have to learn regardless. Like you're going to learn because you're in a position like they can not train. So failure is inevitable. But it's not about failing. It's about are going to learn from the fuck up or, you know, like keep fucked up and then just ruin it for yourself.

Speaker 1 [00:51:15] Yeah, I think that's how you learn the best is when you do fuck up because then you really pay attention to not doing that again.

Speaker 2 [00:51:23] Yeah. And like, I'm comfortable enough to tell her that I fucked up.

Speaker 1 [00:51:27] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:51:28] The point where she's like, Oh, yeah, You know, like. Like, Hey, I fucked up too. It's okay. Like, she's not. She's not like, Oh, you're an idiot. Like, you really fucked up. Like, you really, like, did something like that. Like, she actually, like, listens and understands.

Speaker 1 [00:51:43] Yeah. And she gives you, like, empathy for it.

Speaker 2 [00:51:46] Yeah, definitely.

Speaker 1 [00:51:48] And when I asked the statements, my partner is usually responsive to my needs. You could say seven. Very true. Can you give me an example of when this has happened and why did you answer? Seven?

Speaker 2 [00:52:08] Not like a specific example, but I think sometimes my needs are not actually what I need. It's just like what I think I need. Just like, in a very vague way. Like. Like, I think I need to do something or I guess like. I guess like, I guess this is a good, good one to think of. Like, I'm trying to do a diet plan with my girlfriend and like, I was like, tracking what I was eating. But I was like, really focused on like less carbs, like eat less carbs, always like, oh, I can buy this because there's too many carbs in it. And then, like, you know, she was like, dude, like, you're starting to, like, make that an unhealthy habit.

And I was like, No, Like I'm trying to just eat better. And then like, I started realizing like, oh, damn, like. You know, like I thought, I guess at first, like, she was like. Didn't really give a shit about like how I felt about it or, you know, like I was trying to take it serious. And she was like, Oh, like it's not that big of a deal. Oh, I. I felt like, okay, so you don't like because you don't think it's a big deal and you don't care about, like, what I want out of it.

Speaker 1 [00:53:20] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:53:21] Because, you know, I was wrong, but.

Speaker 1 [00:53:25] And so you gave a seven because it's like these types of things occur, like, not often, but on more than one occasion.

Speaker 2 [00:53:34] Yeah. Yeah. More than one occasion where it's. More of it's not more of like, oh, like, you know, my actual needs, but it's what I want versus like, what I actually can like what I actually. Deserve or need, I guess.

Speaker 1 [00:53:52] Okay. And. All right. Now we're getting into the fun stuff. So I hope you don't mind if I ask. And feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share. But I also want to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:54:15] Not super often. Probably once or twice every couple of weeks.

Speaker 1 [00:54:24] Sorry. Once or twice. Okay. And how satisfied are you with your sex life? And why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:54:34] Probably. Like on a scale like 1 to 10? Yeah, I mean, like one being like we satisfied, like probably a six. And I think purely because, like, I feel like I don't have like, energy after working like, you know, 11 hours and then like going to the gym. But then I'm also like, okay, like, I think it's all just like psychological. So, like, make me feel like I'm like, not putting out enough. And then that's like making her dissatisfied, which makes me feel like, oh, like I'm. I'm fucking up. Like, I'm, you know, now I'm self-conscious about, like, what I'm doing.

Speaker 1 [00:55:15] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:55:17] I think it's purely based on me. Like if she's down. And I'm not. Then I've been. We're both feeling unsatisfied from it because I'm like, Oh, great. Like now I know she's like going to be upset about it and that she's also like, Damn, like, that's, you know, shitty.

Speaker 1 [00:55:34] You know? But I mean, it is a reasonable excuse working all day, working out like it's exhausting.

Speaker 2 [00:55:41] Yeah, it's exhausting. But it's not, like, completely. Like an excuse because there will be like some random times where like, you know, there will be like a random moment. Like, I'm like, let's do it, you know? Yeah, like I. I feel like I am trying too hard to, like, control the situation sometimes. So like it.

Speaker 1 [00:56:01] More about, like, on your terms.

Speaker 2 [00:56:04] Yeah. Which I don't like at all. Yeah, I still do it.

Speaker 1 [00:56:10] We have. You try to, like, change out of all.

Speaker 2 [00:56:13] Yeah, I've tried to change it. I don't know why it's difficult at times, but it's like just a work in progress. Always.

Speaker 1 [00:56:21] Yeah. I mean, as long as you're working on it, that's all that matters, you know, takes time. And. So I asked you earlier, in general, how satisfied with you are you with your relationship and you put completely satisfied. And. And why would you say so?

Speaker 1 [00:56:47] I think.

Speaker 2 [00:56:48] There's another. So I would say so.

Speaker 2 [00:56:51] But I think I'm completely satisfied with my relationship because I know it's always headed in the right path. Although like there's always like, oh, you know, like, I want this happen this to happen Like I, I know now that like, it's exactly what I wanted out of life. It's exactly like what I had hoped for in the past. Like what I want my future to look like. So like being able to, like, look at what how I was then versus now. Like, I know, like, this is exactly where I want it to be. So I, like, makes me feel like, okay, I know I'm like extremely happy with where I am and like, what's going on?

Speaker 1 [00:57:38] Think I asked you on a number scale. Yeah, I think I was on a number scale from 1 to 10. How satisfied are you with your relationship? And I believe you put an eight.

Speaker 2 [00:57:56] Yeah. The reason why. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:57:59] Okay. Yeah. Um. Why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:58:02] Um. Only because, like, I always want to, like, take it to the next step. Like, you know. Proposal getting married, going, like going places together. Like doing a lot of things I like right now. It's not like extremely easy for us to do and like, of course, like having kids in the future, like creating a family, doing these things. Like, you know, you kind of think about doing when like your younger. Yeah. And I'm. I'm very eager for it all to happen, like, as soon as possible. But I feel like I'm, like, still getting on the stepping stones. So it makes it like I'm just not completely satisfied with like, everything that I want to be like regarding like what I want to do. But. But yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:58:55] You do have like house kids and stuff like that. That's when you'd say you'd feel like completely satisfied. Like once you built like, family and stability.

Speaker 2 [00:59:03] Yeah, I think so. I think it's kind of like a never ending hamster wheel. Because at the end of the day, like you are, you are satisfied when you think about like what you want. I guess it's just a mindset thing, like being able to know you're satisfied in those types of moments. I'm sure like in the future I'll be like, Oh yeah, You know, like, yeah, this is exactly where I want it to be. And like, then I would be satisfied if I saw where I was now. But then in the future, all I'm going to be like, Oh, you know, I want all my kids like go to college and have like great careers and, you know, like, be able to retire and do

like, you know, fun things like, you know, be able to still be like, on top of life, you know, what am I like Then why.

Speaker 1 [00:59:49] You know, as was like, really thoughtful way to think about that question. I had like usually people when they say about their vacation, it's like in their current how they currently like are satisfied within the span of their relationship like you know, they're not thinking about like, I will be 100% satisfied when we get to this level. So I was like really thoughtful. So last question. Did the relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 2 [01:00:22] Yes. Yeah. I would think it would. Because I didn't I didn't expect a lot for myself out of it felt like I met my expectations and exceeded that. So I definitely met and went beyond like what I thought it could have.

Speaker 1 [01:00:44] That's awesome. Now it seems like for her to like. What you said before. I like you guys, like change for the better. You know? So we are close to wrapping up. And I would just like to summarize kind of what we talked about within the past hour or so. So like summarize it. You guys have been dating for [1-5] years and started off just like mostly face timing, like getting to know each other. And then you guys really just like, took off your relationship once you guys were able to hang out in person. And usually you have a really solid relationship. I mean, of course there's like fights here and there, but minuscule stuff, things that don't really matter. And then the things that do matter, you guys come to a compromise and work things out. Let's see what else. Seems like you guys are, like, really looking for or you're really looking forward to, like, a future with her and feeling safe and stable in the relationship. And the biggest thing I really heard is like, you feel secure and you have like a lot of trust in her and like even in yourself, it seems like. Is there anything else? Is that right? And is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [01:02:07] That's right. Yeah. Can I go on?

Speaker 1 [01:02:11] I want to kind of shortly summarize a lot of what we talked about. But. I want to thank you again for doing this interview. And before we end, I kind of want to just talk a little bit how we handle the data. So for the research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And I mean, like you're going to pick which data sharing option that you want to do. So option one is going to say it on your consent form. But I'll just kind of explain it a little bit more. So option one is it is the transcript portion that can be shared, none of which the none of which can be identified to you. So it's a de-identified transcript that can also be read by other researchers, researchers. And then the second option is more of a bolder option. And is that the whole transcript can be shared, removed of any sensitive, sensitive information or any over identifying information. And it will be anonymous, obviously, although this option, there's little there's very minimal chance that somebody now will piece together the details of the transcript and narrow down among who their colleagues they believe it is. But no. So basically, the second option is like, is somebody very close to you reads it or like they read the research or the transcript, they can like identify it towards you. But your name, your girlfriend's name won't be like put in or like where you guys live and stuff like that. Like nothing. Anything like won't really be identified towards you unless it like your best friend or you like your dad read it or somebody that knows you very well.

Speaker 2 [01:04:01] Let's find.

Speaker 1 [01:04:02] This one. Okay. I want to thank you again for the last time for participating in this study. We also want you to know a little bit how we handle the data or

this actually the study. How we handle the studies being conducted in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and the US. And yeah, I don't need and yeah, that's it actually. Usually afterwards I like I'll stop.